

CLAUDE.md

This file is auto-loaded by Claude Code at the start of every session in this repository. It captures the cross-session rules, locked decisions, and conventions for the Supportive project. Read it before doing anything else.

What this project is

Supportive is an Australian job directory for mental health and supportive services roles. It covers clinical mental health, AOD (alcohol and other drugs), peer work, NDIS-funded community services, and allied health. The audience is candidates looking for mission-aligned roles and employers who want to hire from a pool that self-selects for values alignment rather than salary alone.

The site is not a generic job board with a mental health filter. It is a mental-health-first directory that happens to use a job board as its surface.

Live URL (staging): <https://supportive-omega.vercel.app/>

Current stage: Week 1 of build — transforming a generic template into the niched Australian MH product. See [PLAN.md](#) for the full Week 1 scope.

How we work together

1. **Show diffs before committing.** Every change, show a diff and wait for approval. Do not commit unilaterally.
2. **Ask before installing new dependencies.** If a task needs a package not already in `package.json`, ask first.
3. **Prefer editing existing code over introducing new abstractions.** This is a template being reshaped, not a greenfield rebuild. Resist the urge to rewrite.
4. **Narrow sequential turns beat big parallel ones.** If a task has more than ~5 distinct file changes, propose a plan and execute it in passes rather than one mega-turn. Past experience with this codebase has hit stream timeouts on oversized parallel tool-use turns.
5. **Update `BUILD_NOTES.md` as you go.** Log decisions, gotchas, and things to revisit. Future sessions depend on this file.
6. **If you're unsure, ask.** Cheap to clarify, expensive to redo. Do not guess at product decisions.
7. **When in a scope-guard zone, stop and surface.** The "NOT in scope" list in [PLAN.md](#) is binding for Week 1. If something feels tempting but is on that list, ask rather than acting.

Locked decisions (do not change without asking)

These are the non-negotiable product decisions for Week 1. If a proposed change touches any of them, pause and ask.

The 18-role taxonomy

Clinical: Psychologist, Clinical Psychologist, Psychiatrist, Mental Health Nurse, Mental Health Occupational Therapist.

Allied health: Mental Health Social Worker, Counsellor, Psychotherapist, Art / Music / Play Therapist, Dietitian (Eating Disorders).

Community / NDIS: Peer Support Worker, Lived Experience Worker, Support Worker (Mental Health), AOD Worker, Youth Mental Health Worker, Case Manager / Care Coordinator.

Leadership & specialist: Clinical Lead / Team Leader, Mental Health Educator / Trainer.

Category slugs: [clinical](#), [allied-health](#), [community-ndis](#), [leadership](#). Full slug list for each role is in [PLAN.md](#).

Geography

- Australia only. AUD currency. AU cities. AU states.
- Default locations: Sydney, Melbourne, Brisbane, Perth, Adelaide, Canberra, Hobart, Darwin, Newcastle, Wollongong, Gold Coast, Geelong, plus Remote (Australia) and Hybrid.
- State enum: NSW, VIC, QLD, WA, SA, ACT, TAS, NT.
- Dates: DD/MM/YYYY or relative ([2 days ago](#)). Never MM/DD/YYYY.
- Locale: [en-AU](#).

Three-layer page architecture

- **Layer 1** — Editorial hubs ([/roles/\[role\]](#), [/employers/\[employer\]](#), [/specialties/\[specialty\]](#)). Always indexable. Hand-written content. ~40 pages at maturity.
- **Layer 2** — Dense matrix pages ([/roles/\[role\]/\[location\]](#)). Indexable only when listings and content thresholds are met. ~250 pages at maturity.
- **Layer 3** — Long tail. Pages exist but [noindex](#) until they earn their way in. ~750 pages built, indexed as inventory grows.

Noindex threshold rule

A page is indexable only if ALL three are true:

1. At least 3 active job listings, OR at least 5 historical listings shown as "recent roles"
2. At least 300 words of unique content (excluding nav, footer, listing cards)
3. A unique meta description (not auto-generated boilerplate)

Always-indexable routes (rule does not apply): `/`, `/jobs`, `/jobs/[id]`, `/roles/[role]`, `/employers/[employer]`, `/specialties/[specialty]`, and all static pages.

Apply the rule to: `/roles/[role]/[location]` and any future Layer 3 routes.

Code and content conventions

Writing style (all UI copy, meta tags, documentation)

- **Sentence case everywhere.** Headings, buttons, labels, nav items. Never Title Case.
- **Australian English spelling.** `organisation`, `specialise`, `centre`, `colour`, `behaviour`, `programme` (for a structured programme — `program` is fine for software). When in doubt: Macquarie Dictionary over Merriam-Webster.
- **Plain, direct prose.** No marketing superlatives. No "revolutionary", "game-changing", "lifetime access", "guaranteed". This is a directory, not a pitch.
- **No emoji in UI copy or commits.** (User does not use emoji; neither should the site.)
- **Inclusive, non-stigmatising language for mental health.** Never "suffers from", "commits suicide", "the mentally ill", "a schizophrenic". Use "lives with", "died by suicide", "people experiencing mental illness", "a person with schizophrenia". When in doubt, refer to Mindframe's guidelines (<https://mindframe.org.au/>).

Code style

- Follow the existing conventions in the codebase. Match the framework's idioms (App Router patterns if Next.js, etc.) rather than introducing your own.
- TypeScript strict mode if available. Prefer explicit types at module boundaries; let inference handle the rest.
- Small, single-purpose components. If a component file exceeds ~200 lines, propose a split before continuing.
- Use the project's existing styling approach (Tailwind + shadcn/ui based on what I've seen). Do not introduce a second styling system.
- Database schema changes: always show the migration before running it. Never drop columns or tables without confirmation.

- Tests are good but not required for every change. Required for: the noindex helper, any schema-to-schema data mapping, any pricing or money math (none in Week 1).

Commit conventions

- One section from `PLAN.md` = one commit.
- Commit message format: `Section N: <short description>`, e.g. `Section 3: 18-role MH taxonomy`.
- Commit messages in sentence case, no emoji, no Conventional Commits prefixes (`feat:`, `fix:`) unless the existing repo already uses them.
- Never force-push to main or to any shared branch.

Session workflow

- Start each Week 1 section as a fresh Claude Code session (`claude` in the repo directory, not `claude --continue`). Context stays lean.
- First action in every session: `/rename` with a readable name like `week1-s3-taxonomy`. This keeps the session picker usable when resuming later.
- Within a section, `claude --continue` is the right way to resume after a break.
- Use `/compact` if a session's context gets heavy mid-section (long file reads, lots of tool results).
- Always end a section with a clean commit before closing the session.

Files to know about

- `PLAN.md` — The Week 1 build plan. Read in full at the start of any Week 1 session.
- `BUILD_NOTES.md` — Running log of decisions, gotchas, and things to revisit. Created in Section 0 and updated throughout. Consult this before repeating any architectural discussion.
- `CLAUDE.md` — This file. Auto-loaded every session.

What we are NOT building in Week 1

These are explicitly deferred. If a task seems to need one of these, stop and ask.

- Real job feed integrations (Adzuna, Greenhouse, Lever, Workday, PageUp) — Week 2
- Full editorial hub content — Week 3 (first 5 roles only)
- Employer dashboard / job posting flow — Week 4+
- Payments, Stripe, subscription tiers, featured-listing upsells — post-launch
- Matching wizard, AI recommendations, semantic search — post-launch
- Email notifications, job alert signups — post-launch
- Auth flow polish beyond what's already in the template — only if actively broken
- Analytics beyond basic Vercel Analytics — post-launch

- Third-party integrations (Slack, Typeform, etc.) — post-launch
- Any ML or AI features — post-launch

If any of these become necessary to complete a Week 1 task, surface it and wait for direction rather than acting.

Product tone notes

Two audiences, one voice.

For candidates — the site should feel like it was built by someone who understands the sector. That means using the right role names (a peer worker is not a "customer success representative"), acknowledging the emotional weight of the work, and treating salary bands honestly (most MH roles don't pay six figures — don't pretend otherwise).

For employers — the site should feel like a trustworthy distribution channel, not a recruitment marketplace. No pushy upsells. No urgency tactics. No "post your job in 60 seconds" banners. The value proposition is quality of audience, not speed of flow.

Everything about the tone should be closer to ethicaljobs.com.au than seek.com.au. Mission-first. Australian. Quietly confident rather than shouty.

Escalation triggers

Stop work and ask the user if any of these come up:

- A task in [PLAN.md](#) turns out to be materially larger than expected (e.g. no existing schema, need a full DB rebuild).
- A locked decision seems wrong based on what you're seeing in the code.
- A dependency install is needed.
- A destructive operation is about to happen (dropping data, force push, deleting files).
- An acceptance criterion can't be met without scope changes.
- Something in [/PLAN.md](#)'s "NOT in scope" list feels necessary to unblock Week 1.

When escalating, be specific: state the problem, state what you'd recommend, and wait.